PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

September 15, 2026
Regular Board Meeting

Meeting Minutes

Adopted 10/6/26

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Regular Board Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at the Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center, Board Auditorium, 501 N. Dixon St., Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at:

https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Present:

Chair Eddie Wang; Vice-Chair Rashelle Chase-Miller; Director Michelle DePass; Director Stephanie Englesman; Director Virginia La Forte; Director Christy Splitt; Director Patte Sullivan; Zahra Faruqui (for Student Representative Rose Sandell) and Superintendent Kimberlee Armstrong

Call to Order / Opening

Chair Wang called the meeting to order at 6:04 pm.

Student and Public Comment

- Naomi Anderson – Fifth-grade student at Faubion Elementary spoke about the impact that class size has on her learning.
- Afton Wilcox – Spoke about equitable access to education, suggested selling the PEC building and relocating central office staff into underenrolled schools, and asked for the seismic-safety scenarios previously requested.
- Zach Keirsey – Benson Polytechnic graduate and School Resource Officer shared his personal experience and offered to help the District think through student safety and police interactions.
- Lisa Jackson – Raised concerns about the pace of bond-funded improvements to the Indian Education Center, superintendent compensation, and data practices.
- Elizabeth Doerr – Faubion parent who urged the Board to prioritize and adequately resource neighborhood schools throughout the rightsizing process.
- Amy Woodman – Glencoe Elementary PTA president who asked the Board to add academic-outcome and educational-continuity safeguards to the Rightsizing framework, including publishing receiving-school data alongside any closure scenario.
- Chelsea Riordan – Rigler Elementary parent who asked for alternatives to closure, transparency of anticipated savings, and voiced support for Director Englesman's Rightsizing resolution.
- Mary Nesmith – PPS school social worker and parent who advocated for restoring indoor restroom access for families using the PPS clothing center at the Marshall campus.

- Jennifer Siegel – PPS counselor and Metropolitan Learning Center (MLC) parent who asked the Board to maintain and expand funding for MLC and other experiential learning programs.
- Nick Biller – Rigler Elementary parent who asked the District to fix inconsistent and outdated scheduling information posted for Rightsizing community meetings.
- Matt Landon – Bike safety consultant who provided an update on Bike Bus PDX screening practices and raised concerns about the conduct of other community bike-ride groups near Abernethy Elementary.

Comments from our Union Partners

Portland Association of Teachers (PAT) President Alicia Chavez shared appreciation for the contributions of classified staff. She urged the Board to authentically engage all educators and classified staff as decisions are made about the future of schools during the Rightsizing process.

2026-2029 Agreement between Portland Federation of School Professionals and School District No. 1J (Resolution 7381)

Senior Director of Human Resources Stacy Jung and Portland Federation of School Professionals (PFSP) President Elizabeth Held introduced the three-year agreement.

Ms. Held and PFSP Political Education Vice President Amaro Moon both provided comments. Ms. Held stated support for the Board to approve the contract, noting the difference in compensation for PFSP employees given the Superintendent's recent contract extension. Mx. Moon stated objections to the difference between the negotiated PFSP cost-of-living increase and the Superintendent's compensation package, urging the Board to direct more funds to classified staff and students.

Actions:

- Director Splitt moved, and Vice-Chair Chase-Miller seconded the motion to adopt Resolution 7381, 2026-2029 Agreement between Portland Federation of School Professionals and School District No. 1J. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed unanimously (7 yes – 0 no – 0 abstain).

2025-26 Integrated Grants Annual Report and Student Investment Account Update

Chief of Student Support Services Jey Buno and Senior Director State & Federal Programs, Dr. Camedra Jefferson presented the annual report required by the Oregon Department of Education (ODE). Board Members had questions about Perkins funding and the integrated English Language Development model. Public Comment was available, but no members of the public signed up to comment.

Bond Program Update

Presenters: Jon Franco-Chief of Operations; Sarah Normn-Executive Director, Real Estate, Infrastructure and School Enhancement; Joanna Evenson-Senior Director, Real Estate, Infrastructure and School Enhancement; Maya Vinson-Financial Services Manager

Staff presented the quarterly bond update, noting a revised project-status reporting method. Board discussion covered a range of topics: the timeline for Powell Park turf improvements relative to the Cleveland High School opening; transportation difficulties for students traveling between the former Cleveland campus and the Marshall campus, an appeal filed by the Hillsdale Neighborhood Association related to the Ida B. Wells modernization,external construction auditor engagement; and restroom access at PTA Clothing Center located on the Marshall Campus.

8:45 pm to 8:56 pm - Break

Update: Rightsizing

Presenters: Jon Franco-Senior Chief of Operations; Margaret Calvert-Executive Director of School Planning and Modernization; RIchard Smith-Senior Director of Data and Accountability

Staff presented the decision-making framework and key performance indicators (KPIs) that will be used to develop and evaluate rightsizing scenarios.

Staff provided an update on the projected number of schools meeting stable enrollment thresholds if no changes occur. Staff also shared an overview of schools with split feeder patterns.

There were questions on how “well-resourced” or “well-balanced” will be defined and measured; whether class size will be considered when developing scenarios; how building conditions will be factors; building efficiency calculations; and the timeline for community and educator engagement. Staff stated that scenarios would be released in early October, with Board discussion targeted for the October 6 meeting. There were questions about whether all schools would meet the criteria of “well-resourced” after implementation, and the continued enrollment decline.

Discussion: Resolution to Direct the Superintendent to Conduct a Span of Control Assessment on the Central Office Leadership Team

Director Englesman introduced a resolution directing staff to complete a span-of-control assessment of the central office leadership team. There was general agreement, with the preference to direct the Superintendent as an operational request, rather than a formal resolution. Superintendent Armstrong agreed that an analysis would be ready for the Board’s first meeting in December.

Discussion: Rightsizing Resolution

Director Englesman shared a draft resolution to pursue cost saving measures, including withholding cost-of-living increases for higher paid staff, seeking funds from the City, and reviewing prior board resolutions for unused set-aside funds.

The majority Board did not support moving the resolution forward, stating concerns about board members directing day-to-day operations, and the volume of major work already underway.

Consent Agenda: Resolutions 7377 through 7379

Actions:

- Director La Forte moved, and DIrector Sullivan seconded the motion to adopt the Consent Agenda. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed unanimously (7 yes - 0 no - 0 abstain).

Grice-Adair Center Project: Exemption from Competitive Bidding and Authorization for Use of a Construction Manager/General Contractor Alternative Contracting Method (Resolution 7380)

Director La Forte requested clarification on the project budget referenced in the draft findings; staff confirmed the $60 million figure includes the $16 million already spent to purchase the Grice-Adair building, leaving approximately $44 million for the remaining project.

Actions:

Director Splitt moved, and Director La Forte seconded the motion to adopt Resolution 7380, Grice-Adair Center Project: Exemption from Competitive Bidding and Authorization for Use of a Construction Manager/General Contractor Alternative Contracting Method. The motion was put to a vote and unanimously passed (7 yes – 0 no – 0 abstain).

Other Business, Committee Referrals, and Future Agenda Items

- There was a request to discuss restroom access for visitors of the PTA Clothing Closet located on the Marshall Campus. Chief of Staff, Deborah Kafoury indicated the staff are working to resolve the issue directly.
- Director DePass proposed forming a work group of parents, educators, students, and other stakeholders to address student screen-time use.
- Committee chairs were reminded to send in their Committee Reports.

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned at approximately 11:22 pm by Chair Wang.

Submitted by:

Rosanne Powell
Senior Board Manager/Board Secretary
Portland Public Schools

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at:
https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Resolutions As Adopted

No.	Title	Page
7377	Expenditure Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority ……	
7378	Revenue Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority …….	
7379	Settlement Agreement ……..	
7380	Grice-Adair Center Project: Exemption from Competitive Bidding and Authorization for Use of a Construction Manager/ General Contractor Alternative Contracting Method ……..	
7381	2026-2029 Agreement between Portland Federation of School Professionals and School District No. 1J, Multnomah County, Oregon ……	

RESOLUTION No. 7377

Expenditure Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority

RECITAL

Portland Public Schools ("District") Public Contracting Rules PPS-45-0200 ("Authority to Approve District Contracts; Delegation of Authority to Superintendent") requires the Board of Education ("Board") enter into contracts and approve payment for products, materials, supplies, capital outlay, equipment, and services whenever the total amount exceeds $150,000 per contract, excepting settlement or real property agreements. Contracts meeting this criterion are listed below.

RESOLUTION

The Superintendent recommends that the Board approve these contracts. The Board accepts this recommendation and by this resolution authorizes the authorized signer per the Purchasing and Contracting Delegation of Authority Administrative Directive (8.50.105-AD) to enter into the following agreements.

NEW CONTRACTS

No New Contracts

NEW COOPERATIVE PURCHASING AGREEMENTS

No New Cooperative Purchasing Agreements

NEW INTERGOVERNMENTAL AGREEMENTS ("IGAs")

Contractor	Contract Term	Contract Type	Description of Services	Contract Amount	Responsible Administrator, Funding Source
Lake Oswego School District	7/1/2026 Through 6/30/2027	Intergovernmental Agreement IGA 98285	Partner to deliver regional services to eligible individuals with Autism Spectrum Disorder.	$197,000	J. Buno Fund: Grant Dept: 5433
Oregon City School District	7/1/2026 Through 6/30/2027	Intergovernmental Agreement IGA 98287	Partner to deliver regional services to eligible individuals with Autism Spectrum Disorder.	$220,000	J. Buno Fund: Grant Dept: 5433
Centennial School District	7/1/2026 Through 6/30/2027	Intergovernmental Agreement IGA 98288	Partner to deliver regional services to eligible individuals with Autism Spectrum Disorder.	$168,000	J. Buno Fund: Grant Dept: 5433
West Linn-Wilsonville School District	7/1/2026 Through 6/30/2027	Intergovernmental Agreement IGA 98290	Partner to deliver regional services to eligible individuals with Autism Spectrum Disorder.	$211,000	J. Buno Fund: Grant Dept: 5433
North Clackamas School District	7/1/2026 Through 6/30/2027	Intergovernmental Agreement IGA 98297	Partner to deliver regional services to eligible individuals with Autism Spectrum Disorder.	$602,000	J. Buno Fund: Grant Dept: 5433

AMENDMENTS TO EXISTING CONTRACTS

No New Amendments

*A Certified Business is a for-profit business certified as a Minority-Owned Businesses (MBE), Women-Owned Businesses (WBE), Emerging Small Businesses (ESB), and/or Service-Disabled Veteran Businesses (SDV) by the State of Oregon Certification Office for Business Inclusion and Diversity.

RESOLUTION No. 7378

Revenue Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority

RECITAL

Portland Public Schools ("District") Public Contracting Rules PPS-45-0200 ("Authority to Approve District Contracts; Delegation of Authority to Superintendent") requires the Board of Education ("Board") enter into contracts, except as otherwise expressly authorized. Contracts exceeding $150,000 per contractor are listed below.

RESOLUTION

The Superintendent recommends that the Board approve these contracts. The Board accepts this recommendation and by this resolution authorizes the authorized signer per the Purchasing and Contracting Delegation of Authority Administrative Directive (8.50.105-AD) to enter into the following agreements.

NEW REVENUE CONTRACTS

No new Revenue Contracts

NEW INTERGOVERNMENTAL AGREEMENTS ("IGAs")

No New Intergovernmental Agreements

AMENDMENTS TO EXISTING CONTRACTS

Contractor	Amendment Term	Contract Type	Description of Services	Amendment Amount; New Contract Amount	Responsible Admin, Funding Source
State of Oregon	9/16/2026 Through 6/30/2027	Intergovernmental Agreement / Revenue IGA/R 97076 Amendment 1	Amendment adds Grant Year 2 Funds to High Success Agreement with the Oregon Department of Education.	$13,463,950.05 $26,087,323.69	K. Howard

RESOLUTION No. 7379

Settlement Agreement

The Board of Education grants authority to pay a total of $209,999.98 to resolve a disputed claim. The settlement agreement will be in a form approved by the Contracted General Counsel.

RESOLUTION NO. 7380

Grice-Adair Center Project: Exemption from Competitive Bidding and Authorization for Use of a Construction Manager/ General Contractor Alternative Contracting Method

RECITALS

A. The Board of Directors of Portland Public Schools ("District") is the Local Public Contract Review Board ("Board") pursuant to ORS 279A.060.

B. ORS 279C.335(2) authorizes the Board to exempt certain public contracts or classes of contracts from the standard competitive bidding process otherwise required by the Public Contracting Code and Rules upon certain findings.

C. In a duly and legally held election on November 3, 2020, general obligation bonds were approved by a majority of the qualified voters of Portland Public Schools voting at the election ("2020 Capital Improvement Bonds").

D. The District intends to perform the design phase of the Grice-Adair Center Public Improvement Project ("Grice-Adair Center Project") as part of the 2020 Capital Improvement Bond work.

E. Staff has determined that use of the Construction Manager/ General Contractor ("CM/GC") alternative contracting method is the preferred method of delivery for the complex Grice-Adair Project. This determination is supported by draft Findings of Fact ("Draft Findings") presented to the Board pursuant to ORS 279C.335.

F. These Draft Findings specify the cost savings and design, scheduling, operational, safety, and logistical advantages gained through use of the CM/GC contracting method.

G. On August 14, 2026, the District issued a public notice in the Daily Journal of Commerce announcing the District's intent to utilize the CM/GC alternative contracting method for the Grice-Adair Center Project. The notice was issued in compliance with ORS 279C.335 and the PPS Public Contracting Rules. The Draft Findings were made available for public review on the date of publication. The notice included instructions for requesting a public hearing on the request for exemption from competitive bidding.

H. The District received no requests for a public hearing.

I. The Superintendent recommends approval of the exemption from Competitive Bidding and approval of the CM/GC alternative contracting method for solicitation and completion of the Grice-Adair Center Project.

RESOLUTION

1. The Board hereby adopts the Draft Findings in support of use of the CM/GC alternative contracting method for the Grice-Adair Center Project ("Findings").

2. The Board hereby exempts the Grice-Adair Center Project from competitive bidding requirements as provided in ORS 279C.335 and PPS Public Contracting Rules -49-0600 through PPS-49-0690. The exemption is based upon the Findings pursuant to ORS 279C.335(2).

3. Pursuant to these Findings and decision, the Superintendent or her designee is hereby authorized to conduct a CM/GC alternative contracting process for the Grice-Adair Center Project.

RESOLUTION No. 7381

2026-2029 Agreement between Portland Federation of School Professionals and School District No. 1J, Multnomah County, Oregon

RECITALS

The 2026-2029 Collective Bargaining Agreement between School District No. 1J, Multnomah County,Oregon (Portland Public Schools) and the Portland Federation of School Professionals expired on June 30, 2026.

RESOLUTION

The Portland Public Schools Board of Education (Board) adopts and approves the 2026–2029 Collective Bargaining Agreement between the Portland Public Schools and the Portland Federation of School Professionals attached hereto as Exhibit A. The Superintendent or designee is authorized to make technical corrections to the Agreement in order to correct typographical and spelling errors, make formatting changes, or renumber provisions, so long as the intended meaning of the Agreement is not thereby altered.